Said Townsend, “There’s some very organic shapes to Hydra. I think one of the art directors was saying that there’s a lot of organic shapes of the skeletal structure in some of the buildings. If you had honey between two slices of bread and you pull them apart, you get that gooey, stretched, sort of organic thing. And that is the inspiration for the shapes, that sort of hollowing out of a structure as it’s pulled apart. That’s used a lot as our aesthetic within the movie for Hydra. It’s very neat, very strong, very dramatic, very totemic — but it’s more refined than what the Nazis were doing.”

Said Heinrichs, “It was Joe’s thought finally to throw out the clichéd ‘bad guy’s lair’ idea and keep Hydra HQ hidden within the towering Alpine peaks, with only the windows of Schmidt’s lab even remotely visible in the rocky Alpine carapace. All that remains to remind us of the turrets and castellation of the original idea is the natural ‘architecture’ of the mountains.”